How I Think About Change

I subscribe to four key change principles and they are not new. Each one sits on decades of research in how organizations change, how adults learn, and how habits form. I did not invent them. I have stress tested them over 25 years, across companies from Maersk to Swire, and kept the four that held up every time.

What I add is not the theory. It is the discipline of applying all four at once, inside a single organization, over the course of a program. Most change efforts get one or two right. The real work is refusing to skip any of them.

1

Leaders go first

Change starts at the top or it stalls. Teams read their leaders before they read the memo. If the CEO is using AI openly, the organization follows. If the CEO delegates AI to a task force, so does everyone else.

2

Start with the willing

Convert the curious, not the skeptics. A small Pilot Squad of early adopters creates the evidence that pulls the rest of the organization along. Skeptics change their minds when they see their colleagues winning, not when they are told to.

3

Experience beats a lecture

People change when they feel it, not when they hear about it. Demos and slides can set the stage, but the real shift happens when participants do the work themselves. Every Sprint is built around a real problem, not a theory. You leave with something you built.

4

Build habits, not knowledge

One workshop does not change behavior. Fitness is not a fact you learn. It is a practice you keep. I help teams build simple rituals that make AI part of how work gets done: weekly sharing of AI wins, managers asking 'how can AI help you with this?', Pit Stop sessions after each Sprint. Small habits, repeated, turn new skills into permanent ones.

Simple principles. Hard to live by. Worth the work.

Curious? Take the free AI Fitness Test or book a Sprint at **coachbay.ai**